

Taragarh Palace, Palampur

Located in the foothills of the magnificent Dhauladhar mountains, Taragarh Palace was built in 1951 as a summer resort for the royal family of Jammu and Kashmir, and was developed as a heritage hotel in 1971. Its European-inspired architecture with colonnaded patio, pavilions and landscaped gardens makes a pretty picture fringed by 15 acres of woodland and manicured tea estates. The palace's 26 rooms and suites feature vintage furnishing and tiled floors, and come with garden or polo grounds views. The Imperial dining hall offers a mix of Indian, Continental and Chinese fare as well as the traditional Himachali Dham (ceremonial multi-dish vegetarian meal).

Doubles from ₹7,000; taragarhpalace.com

WELCOMHOTEL BY ITC HOTELS, THE SAVOY, MUSSOORIE

Built in the Gothic style, The Savoy opened in 1902 and was a favourite retreat for the British. This luxury hotel has been managed by ITC Hotels since 2009. After extensive interior refurbishment in 2013, the hotel's 80 rooms and suites offer a mix of classic charm and modern conveniences; expect high ceilings, wooden furniture and vintage décor, not to mention views of the Himalaya from most rooms. Take your pick between three dining options, including the multicuisine Grand Dining Hall, The Royal Afghan serving North-West Frontier cusine and the colonial-style Writer's Bar.

Doubles from ₹28,000; itchotels.com

